

How to feed for gut health, performance and happiness!

This book is for you - our beloved horsey tribe.

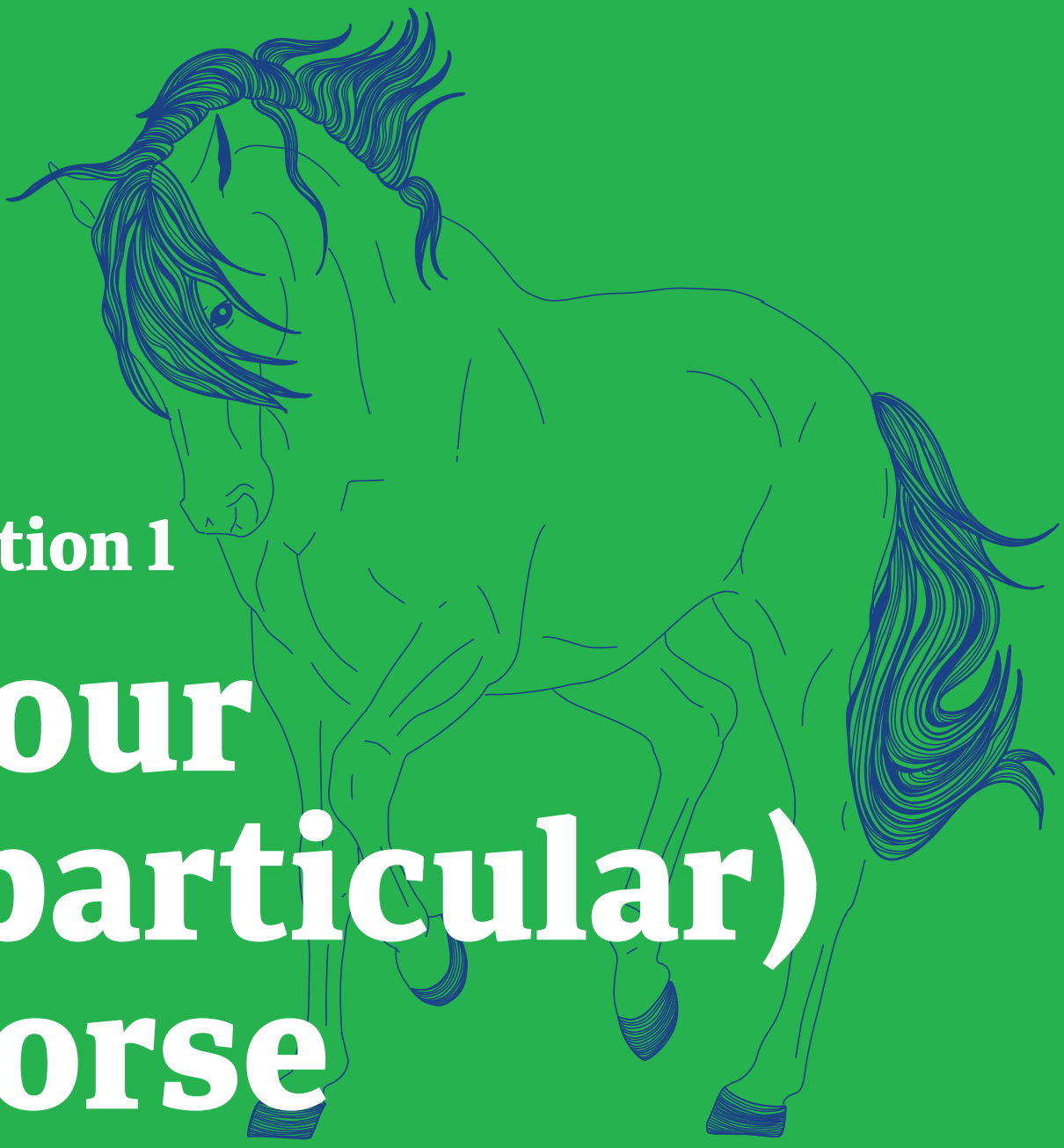
Cards on the table, this book started out as a brochure for our new (and frankly pretty darned amazing) **EasiMash** complete feed, but as we set about writing, it quickly grew into something a whole lot bigger... there's a small section **EasiMash** if you're keen to find out about it, but the rest of this book is purely helpful nutrition infomation - about what your particular horse might need, how to potentially solve a few of life's horse-related challenges, and why we think certain feed ingredients are the bees knees.

We hope you enjoy it and find it useful!

How to use this book.

Of course, feel free to read the whole thing, or you can just jump to the sections most relevant to you. Here they are:

Section 1.	Your (particular) horse	page 3.
1.	Old or sick horses	page 4.
2.	Performance & sport horses	page 6.
3.	Pleasure horses, kid's ponies & paddock pets	page 8.
4.	Racehorses	page 10.
5.	Horses that need help with gut health	page 12.
Section 2.	Problem Solver	page 14.
1.	Gastric ulcers	page 15.
2.	Hindgut dysbiosis	page 17.
3.	'Hot' behaviour	page 19.
4.	Problems gaining weight	page 20.
5.	No appetite/fussy eaters	page 21.
Section 3.	EasiMash	Page 23.
Section 4.	Hero ingredients (all of them)	Page 26.



Section 1

Your (particular) horse

Horses... They take up so much of our time, energy, headspace and (as any parent or spouse of a horsey person will point out) money. And regardless of whether you have an ancient, furry pony or a sleek performance horse grazing out there in the paddock, we horsey folk are all in this for one reason – love.

But whilst love might be the thing that unites us in owning horses, the dreams and challenges you face with YOUR particular horse are unique.

In this section we'll cover off some major categories of horses and provide useful info on how to help keep you more on the dreams (and less on the challenges) side of the equation.



1. Old or sick horses

There are times in life when your horse might need a little bit of extra TLC... old age and when they're ill are just two of them. During these times, receiving a feed that has both the feel-good factor AND all the nutrients they need, is paramount. Here are some facets of feeds to consider:

Comfort food please

Sometimes, your horse just needs a 'big hug in a feed bucket' and in these instances a mash can be in order. As warm or cool, and as sloppy or firm as they like it, mashes are super useful for increasing the comfort-food factor! (And for some reason, they also seem to be feel-good for us to prepare and serve as well).

Slurpability

The slurpability of a feed is helpful (and important) for old horses, who might not have a lot of functioning teeth left and hence have a limited ability to chew. For them, being able to consume enough fibre and energy (calories) per day can pose a real challenge – and is one big reason why old horses can become too skinny. Using a mash feed can easily increase slurpability, and hence the availability of nutrients for your dentally-challenged oldie.

Deliciousness

Fussiness and illness can go hand in hand. If your horse is old, or especially if they are sick or recovering from illness, they may need tempting with a feed that tastes good. This is not the time to offer feeds you know your horse feels a

Teeth

All horses should have their teeth regularly checked and this is even more important for the oldies.

Six-monthly check-ups are desirable, and if you notice them quidding food – that's your cue to get the vet or horse dentist out right away!

bit meh about. That said, if you need to consider other factors like low NSC (if your horse suffers from a metabolic disorder), ensure the feeds you choose are both tasty AND safe.

Balanced

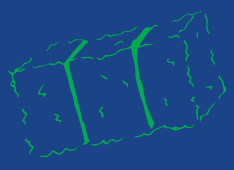
At the best of times you'll want to make sure that between pasture, hay, 'hard' feeds, balancers and/or supplements your horse is getting all the nutrients they need (and we can help you figure that out for your horse, if you need a hand). But when your horse is old, sick, or recovering from illness and their resilience is compromised, the importance of a balanced diet is even greater.

In practical terms this means meeting their requirement for fibre first and foremost, and beyond that ensuring that their diet contains enough energy (calories), quality protein, vitamins and minerals. If you're busy and need to factor in convenience, this probably looks like providing your horse at pasture with hay, chaff and a complete 'hard' feed – which could be an extruded feed, a sweetfeed, a pellet or mash.

Example Diets

The theory is all well and good, but what are some examples of real, balanced diets for horses that are old or unwell?

BUILD A DIET FOR A 500kg aged horse with good teeth or a 500kg sick/recovering horse



CHAFF & HAY

10 kg

Good quality mixed grass and lucerne hay per day

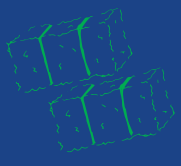
+



1.5 - 2 kg

EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)

BUILD A DIET FOR A 500kg aged horse with poor teeth



HAY CUBES + CHAFF

5 kg

Soaked lucerne & grass hay cubes + chaff (increase up to 9kg if pasture is limited)

+



1.5 - 2 kg

EasiMash® complete feed per day (soaked to a mash)

+



0.5 - 1 kg

EasiFibre® fibre pellet per day (soaked to a mash)

Also allow access to good quality pasture

Note: if you need a safe feed for a horse with PPID, consider replacing EasiMash with EasiSport.



2. Performance & sport horses

When your afternoons and weekends (or entire workdays) are spent in the saddle – or occupied with the thousand other tasks associated with horse ownership – you want to put your best foot forward when you enter the ring. Providing a diet that will give you both every advantage AND not take forever to mix is basically the horse-feed-unicorn you want. So what are some things to consider when designing your horse's diet?

Easiness

Let's be practical – life for most of us is full and complex. And owning a gorgeous, whinnying four-legged friend only adds to that complexity. So one thing most performance horse owners DON'T need is a feeding regime with more steps than a croquembouche recipe. That's why opting for a complete, one-stop 'hard' feed (with plenty of fibre) can be a simplifying game changer.

Quality protein

Beautiful muscle, requires plenty of quality protein (along with an appropriate training regime). But not all protein sources are equal, which is why you might find some feeds seem to help with topline, and others don't do a whole lot. So, look at a feed's ingredients list... Protein sources such as soybean meal, stabilised rice bran, lupins and lucerne are

Don't forget the electrolyte...

And when you're choosing an electrolyte, quality matters! Sodium, chloride and potassium should make up 75%+ of the product to ensure it is replacing what is lost in sweat.

all great sources of essential amino acids, which are the building blocks of protein your horse can use.

No dancing pants thanks

You know what we mean... we've all been for a little impromptu dance around the ring on two hind legs and it's not much fun, nor is it safe. One common reason attributed to horses exhibiting 'hot' or fizzy behaviour is feeding uncooked starch (found in raw cereal grains). Whilst cereal grains can be a great source of energy, they need to be properly cooked to make them more easily digested by the horse. Other 'cool' energy sources are oil and high energy fibres such as lupin hulls.

The yum factor

You're at an event, or your horse is in full work, just when they need it most, they go off their feed... Inappetence – it's not what you want, but it's not uncommon. So, what can you do to keep them eating? Other than doing all the things necessary to avoid ulcers and help the hindgut (eg. feeding hay before work, not feeding raw grains, and providing plenty of fibre), tempting your fussy eater with a feed created to be especially delicious is a trick you can try. Tasty mashes can work well here.

Example Diets

So, what are some examples of real, balanced diets for horses that are in medium to hard work?

BUILD A DIET FOR A 500kg horse in medium work



CHAFF & HAY		
2 + 8 kg	**2 - 2.5 kg**	**60 g**
2kg lucerne hay before work + 8kg average to good quality mixed grass hay	EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)	EasiLyte® electrolye per day

BUILD A DIET FOR A 500kg horse in heavy work



CHAFF & HAY		
2 + 8 kg	**2.5 - 3 kg**	**90 g**
2kg lucerne hay before work + 8kg average to good quality mixed grass hay	EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)	EasiLyte® electrolye per day



3. Pleasure horses, kid's ponies & paddock pets

Some things in life you do JUST for the love of it. Owning pleasure horses, kid's ponies and paddock pets are case in point. As with other companion animals like cats and dogs, you want to nourish your equine friends properly, but often this is in a setting of a busy life and a finite budget. If you have horses you ride on the trails, the beach or in low level competition you'll also care that they're as safe and calm as their innate temperaments will allow. So what are some key features you might look for in a feed?

Safety first

Dealing with a horse that's 'hot' or fizzy can definitely take the pleasure out of pleasure riding. Whilst every horse has their own unique temperament, feeding starch that is hard to digest – in the form of uncooked grains – can contribute to 'hot' behaviour. For this reason, if your horse or pony needs energy beyond that supplied by pasture and hay, opting for 'cooler' energy sources like extruded grain, high energy fibres and oil can be your best bet.

What if I feed a complete feed below the recommended rate?

If you feed a complete 'hard' feed at less than the recommended rate, your horse likely won't be getting their quota of vitamins and minerals – so top up any gaps with a vitamin and mineral supplement or balancer pellet.

Coat shine

There's nothing lovelier than gazing out at the paddock upon your gleaming, healthy horse. We all love a shiny mane, tail and coat. Obviously, coat health is underpinned by a balanced diet overall, but feeding oil can also help. If you'd rather avoid the mess of adding oil to your horse's feed, choose a complete 'hard' feed that contains ingredients that are oil-rich. Canola oil and stabilised rice bran are two good examples.

Balanced

When you own a horse, the list of things to do can feel never-ending! Spending time mixing different feeds might be a daily ritual you treasure, or perhaps it's a chore you'd rather skip. If the latter sounds more like you, consider opting for a one-stop 'hard' feed, such as a complete-feed mash, extruded feed or pellet.

The feelgood factor

This one should not be discounted as too warm and fuzzy to matter. There's nothing quite like your horse's anticipatory pre-feed nickers or sitting in the gathering dark listening to their contented, rhythmic chewing. Choosing a feed that is tasty and deeply satisfying for your horse to eat – as well as safe and balanced – is surely a pleasure for you both to savour. Plenty of long fibre together with a feel-good style of feed such as a mash or sweetfeed are possible options.

Example Diets

What are some examples of real, balanced diets for paddock pets and pleasure horses?

BUILD A DIET FOR A 300kg pony at maintenance



+



6 kg
Average to good quality mixed grass and lucerne hay per day

0.5 - 0.75 kg
EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)

BUILD A DIET FOR A 300kg in light work



+



1 + 5 kg
1kg lucerne hay before work +

5kg average to good quality mixed grass hay

0.75 - 1.25 kg
EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)



4. Racehorses

If you're a thoroughbred trainer you know there are few things more thrilling than watching a horse step up a gear as it comes down the home straight, finishing with what looks like a near full tank of fuel and winning effortlessly. Whilst many things contribute to those spine-tingling wins, nutrition is well up on the list of factors. But racehorse nutrition is a balance...

On one hand, the goal is to keep diets as close to 'natural' as possible, honouring the horses' 55 million years of evolution and the way their gut is designed, in order to keep them physically and mentally healthy. On the other, as a trainer you'll need to push the boundaries of what a horse's gut and body can handle, to fuel them with high energy diets that allow them to consistently train, race hard and fast, recover and go again.

Plenty of forage

The aim here needs to be providing enough forage and the right types and variety of forage to help keep the stomach free of ulcers and the hindgut full of beneficial microbes. Ensuring forage is also fed at the right time – including 2 kg of lucerne hay fed before morning work – is key.

Well-cooked grain for speed

Providing enough – but not too much – high energy grain, that is cooked to perfection will supply your racehorses with digestible starch. This functions to constantly top up the muscles with glycogen – the ultimate fuel for speed.

Oil and VFAs for stamina

In a well-functioning hindgut, the 'good' microbes continually ferment fibre and produce volatile fatty acids (VFAs) which provide the horse with a constant source of energy. This can help provide energy for stamina over longer distances, as can the fatty acids found in quality sources of oil.

BCAAs for muscle-building

The powerhouse that is a racehorse relies on their ability to build and maintain muscle mass. Building muscles requires quality protein and energy per se, but there is more to it... the amino acid leucine – an essential Branched Chain Amino Acid (BCAA) – plays a critical role in switching on the muscle building process. Leucine is found in stabilised rice bran.

Example Diets

What are some examples of real, balanced diets for racehorses in pre-training and full work?

BUILD A DIET FOR A 500kg racehorse in pre-training



CHAFF & HAY

2+8 kg

2kg lucerne hay before work + 8kg good quality mixed lucerne and grass hay and chaff

+



2 - 2.5 kg

EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)

+



1.5 - 2 kg

EasiFeed Three® complete sweetfeed per day

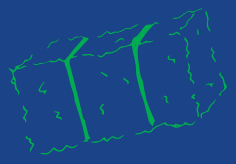
+



60 g

EasiLyte® electrolyte per day

BUILD A DIET FOR A 500kg racehorse in full work



CHAFF & HAY

2+8 kg

2kg lucerne hay before work + 8kg good quality mixed lucerne and grass hay and chaff

+



2 - 2.5 kg

EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)

+



2 - 3 kg

EasiFeed Three® complete sweetfeed per day

+



90 g

EasiLyte® electrolyte per day



5. Horses who need help with gut health

Sloppy poos, sour poos, girthiness, hot or cranky behaviour, eating a lot but still looking skinny – all of these could be the result of unhealthy gut. Poor gut health can happen to a horse at any age or stage of life. The term 'gut' covers both the foregut (the stomach and small intestine), and the hindgut (the caecum and colon). We'll go into more detail on this in the next chapter, but broadly speaking, what are some things you can do to promote good gut health in your horse?

Plenty of forage

All well-balanced horse diets are based on forage and for good reason. Horses need to consume at least 2% of their bodyweight in forage per day. So, for a 300kg horse that's 6kg, for a 400kg horse that's 8kg and for a 500kg horse that's 10kg of forage (pasture, hay and chaff) every single day. If you horse has limited or no access to pasture, or if your pasture is in bad shape, you'll need to provide any shortfall with bought-in forage sources like hay.

A good portion of this forage should take the form of long stem roughage. An important aim when feeding forage is to not only provide this amount but to maximise the amount of TIME your horse spends eating throughout the day and night. Providing hay in a slow feeder or multiple hay nets

Not all grains are as digestible as each other!

... even when they're cooked. Research has found stabilised rice bran to be the MOST digestible of all grains commonly fed to horses!

can help increase the amount of time that your horse spends eating.

Diversity of fibre

It's widely accepted that diversity of fibre sources in the diet correlates with a robust hindgut, essentially because different microbes like eating different fibre types. So to help support your horse's hindgut health, you might want to consider providing a range of fibre sources in their feedbin, in addition to pasture and varied sources of hay. Lucerne leaf meal, lupin hulls, stabilised rice bran and beet pulp are all ideal extra fibre sources.

Feed lucerne hay before work

As a human, the idea of eating and then immediately doing a workout sounds pretty unappealing. But remember that your stomach and your horse's stomach are not built the same way. Whilst we produce gastric acid in response to eating, a horse produces gastric acid 24/7, because in the wild, they'd be eating almost all day long. Constant gut fill both physically protects the delicate, upper (squamous) part of the stomach from acid splash, AND the calcium in lucerne is great for helping to buffer (neutralise the pH of) the stomach acid. For these reasons, feeding some lucerne hay before work is highly recommended.

Avoid raw grain

Grains have long been used as energy sources for horses, and they can be useful, but there's a catch. Ideally, you want grain to be digested in the small intestine and not end up in the hindgut. BUT if grain is fed raw (ie. not cooked), it makes it very difficult for the horse to digest in the small intestine, so down it goes, into the hindgut. A healthy hindgut deals in fibre – not starch – and adding starch to the mix can cause 'bad' microbes to proliferate, killing off the 'good' microbes and reducing hindgut health and functionality. So, if improving hindgut health is your aim, avoid raw grain and opt for feeds containing cooked grains, and/or energy sources such as high energy fibres and oil.

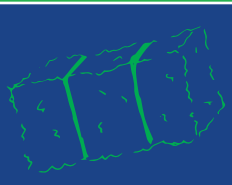
Consider a prebiotic

First, what's the difference between a pro- and pre-biotic? A probiotic contains 'good' microbes, whereas a prebiotic is the food for 'good' microbes. Probiotics introduce new microbes into the gut, whereas prebiotics help to feed the microbes that are already there. In horse feed terms, a feed that includes a yeast prebiotic could help support the hindgut.

Example Diet

What is an example of a diet for a horse recovering from ulcers or hindgut dysbiosis?

BUILD A DIET FOR A 500kg horse in light work recovering from gastric ulcers or hindgut dysbiosis



CHAFF & HAY

2+8 kg

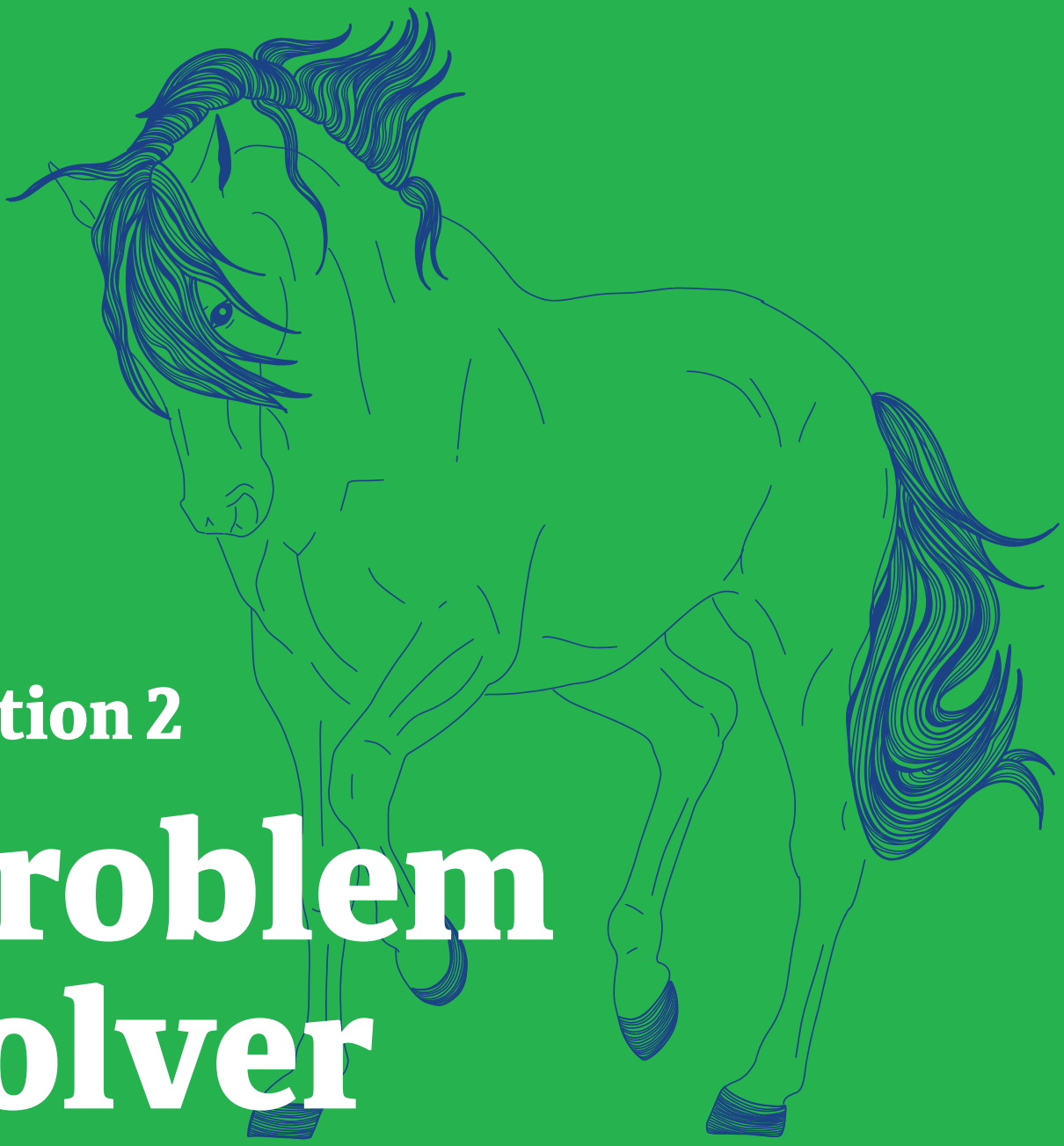
2kg lucerne hay before work + 8kg good quality mixed lucerne and grass hay and chaff fed throughout the day

+



1.5 - 2 kg

EasiMash® complete feed per day (fed dry or soaked to a mash)



Section 2

Problem solver

Life is full of challenges and owning a horse is no exception.

If your horse is a poor doer, a hothead, or a fussy eater to rival the prissiest house cat, you're not alone! Luckily, a lot of challenges just like these can be tackled by tweaking (or sometimes overhauling) the diet.

In this section we take a look at some common feed-related problems and how to potentially help solve them!

1. Gastric ulcers



There is a lot of talk in horsey circles about gastric ulcers or EGUS (Equine Gastric Ulcer Syndrome) but what is really meant by this term? Gastric ulcers are painful sores which form in the lining of the stomach. They can form on the top half of the stomach (Equine Squamous Gastric Disease), which is more common, or the bottom half (Equine Glandular Gastric Disease – which we won't cover here).

Some sources estimate that 50-90% of domesticated horses suffer from squamous gastric ulcers. Horses engaged in higher performance pursuits such as racing and endurance are at higher risk.

Why are horse's susceptible to squamous gastric ulcers?

There are 3 points to note when we're talking about your horse's stomach.

1. Because they evolved to graze for the vast majority of the day and night (and not in distinct 'meals' like us), horses also evolved to secrete gastric acid 24/7. Because they were nearly always grazing, they almost always had some forage present in their stomach which helped protect it against acid splash.

2. The horse's stomach has a top section with delicate squamous tissue and a bottom section which is more robust called the glandular section. If, during exercise for example, acid splashes up onto the delicate squamous section, over time, ulcers can form.

3. When a horse chews, they produce saliva, and that contains bicarbonate, which naturally buffers (or neutralises) gastric acid pH.

Add all of this together and you can see that in a naturally grazing horse, they're not predisposed to ulcers. But in a domesticated situation where we restrict the time that they can graze pasture or eat hay, ask them to exercise for long periods on an empty stomach and feed them large meals, they definitely are! Without the physical barrier of forage in the stomach, a lack of saliva production, plus exercise that can physically cause acid splash onto the top half of the stomach, you have a recipe for squamous ulcers.

How are ulcers diagnosed?

If you suspect your horse has ulcers, work with your vet. Gastroscopy or 'scoping' is the way to find out exactly what's going on.

What can you do to help avoid them?

Helping a horse heal from ulcers, or just aiming to prevent them in the first place involves a multi-pronged approach. Here are some steps you can take to help.

1. **Feed plenty of hay** (especially if pasture is limited). Feeding a minimum of 2% of your horse's body weight per day in roughage is recommended. Feed this in frequent meals throughout the day or make use of hay nets or slow feeders to increase the amount of time your horse spends eating throughout the day and night.

2. **Always feed hay before work** (even if your horse is on good pasture). Lucerne hay is best as it contains high levels of calcium which acts as a further buffer to help neutralise gastric acid pH.

3. **Feed 'hard' feed in small, frequent meals.** Feeding a maximum of 0.5% of your horse's body weight per meal is recommended – which is a maximum of 2.5kg per meal for a 500kg horse.

4. **Opt for supplementary feed that is lower in non-structural carbohydrates (ie. low in starch and sugar).** This could look like a TRULY low grain or grain free feed (but check the ingredients list to make sure). If you do feed some grain in the diet for energy, make sure that it is properly cooked and fed in very small meals.

5. If your horse has been diagnosed with ulcers, **work with your vet** to create a treatment program.



2. Hindgut dysbiosis



Hindgut what? The hindgut is arguably the most important part of a horse. And when it's out of whack (dysbiosis is the technical term), it's likely this will affect your horse's wellbeing in a multitude of ways.

What does the hindgut do?

The horse's hindgut houses trillions of microbes and it's the job of these tiny organisms to digest fibre and release volatile fatty acids – which are a major source of energy (calories) for your horse. They also produce some vitamins, including vitamin B (which helps your horse have a good appetite) and biotin (important for hoof health).

Without these microbes your horse would not be able to digest the relatively indigestible fibre that makes up majority of their diet and they would lack these important B vitamins.

What happens if there is hindgut dysbiosis?

A number of factors including illness, stress, eating insufficient hay, eating raw grain and consuming large grain-based meals, can all throw out the delicate balance of your horse's hindgut. This can lead to a hindgut where there are too many 'bad' microbes (due to rapid starch digestion), and not enough 'good' ones (because of a change in the hindgut environment).

Ultimately, this can result in poor fibre digestion, which in turn can manifest as a number of problems such as difficulty gaining or maintaining weight, hot or 'fizzy' behaviour, lack of appetite, brittle hooves, and in acute cases, a hindgut that's in bad shape can be linked with colic and laminitis.

What can you do to help the hindgut?

In a nutshell, good hindgut health is something you definitely want for your horse and there are three big ticket items you can do to help ensure good hindgut health!

1. Make sure that your horse is fed **plenty of fibre** (at least 2% of their bodyweight per day in forage) is the starting point.

2. Feed a **diversity of fibre sources**, this has been shown to increase the robustness of the hindgut microbial populations.

3. If you do feed grain, **make sure that the grain is cooked** (extruded or pelleted) to increase the likelihood that the starch will be digested in the small intestine before it reaches the hindgut. Read the label of your feed to be sure! Also ensure this is fed in small meals (less than 0.5% of your horses bodyweight per meal).



3. 'Hot' behaviour



Education and innate temperament are both factors impacting your horse's behaviour, but nutrition can also play a major role. Given that trying to ride a fizzy, overly-sensitive or ridiculously self-possessed steed can take the joy out of a ride really fast, it's in our best interest as horse owners to understand what we can do feed-wise to conjure calm.

Don't over feed

Tempting as it may be, you can't just set and forget when it comes to diet. Especially if your horse is prone to 'hot' behaviour. If your horse is in no work or light work, they might have all their nutritional needs met by forage (pasture and/or hay) plus a balancer or a vitamin and mineral pellet.

But if your horse is in moderate or heavy work, they'll likely need a 'hard' feed to provide the nutrition they need. Here's the catch though, they won't need AS MUCH feed on the days they aren't worked, so always match the amount of 'hard' feed you provide with the amount of work they have done an any given day. Too much feed can either manifest as a horse becoming overweight (and therefore sluggish when ridden) OR as a horse who's way too 'hot'.

If you need help figuring out a diet that matches your horse's workload (on days off, days in light work, and days where they work harder), try the EasiFeed Selector tool on our website, or get in touch.

Feed 'cool' energy sources

If your horse does need extra energy to match their workload, avoid feeding raw cereal grains. Either use properly cooked grains (eg. extruded or pelleted) or opt for high energy fibres (such as lupin hulls) or oils and oil-rich ingredients (like stabilised rice bran).

Base the diet on forage

Ensuring that forage is the mainstay of your horse's diet is best practice for numerous nutritional reasons. It helps keep the stomach full and less susceptible to ulcers. It helps keep the hindgut in balance and provides your horse with volatile fatty acids (VFAs), which they can use for consistent, calm energy.

But the act of chewing forage also helps to keep horses feeling mentally happy, peaceful and calm.

4. Problems gaining weight



The owners of off-the-track thoroughbreds are well acquainted with this one – but the dilemma of how to put on or maintain weight is not restricted to thoroughbreds.

Teeth, worms and underlying disease

Whilst switching up the diet can definitely help with weight-gain, you should first look to rule out any other underlying issues. If you're having problems with weight gain, first, it can be useful to conduct a faecal egg count (FEC) and treat with an appropriate wormer. Also have their teeth checked and filed if needed and get the vet to check them out for any other underlying issues such as gastric ulcers or illness.

Once you've covered these bases, it's time to think about diet.

Base the diet on forage

At the risk of sounding like a broken record, forage is your horse's best friend, especially where weight gain is concerned. In a healthy hindgut, microbes use fibre to produce volatile fatty acids, which are THE most important form of energy (ie. calories) for any horse.

If pasture is limited or not available, make sure you're feeding ample hay (a minimum of 2% of their body weight) to meet their forage needs!

Address hindgut health

A well-functioning hindgut is critical for both long term horse health and weight maintenance. Refer to the hindgut dysbiosis section for tips on how to help keep your horse's hindgut healthy.

Feed enough energy

Throughout their lives, horses have variable needs for energy. Mares in early lactation and horses in hard work are two examples of where energy needs are very high! But even horses in moderate work, old horses or those recovering from illness might need extra energy. And if they're not getting enough energy from the diet, your horse will not only not gain weight, they'll lose it.

Try the EasiFeed Selector tool on our website, or reach out to the Pryde's team if you need help matching your horse's energy needs with what you're feeding them.

5. No appetite/ fussy eaters



Aiming to appease your fussy horse can not only be a difficult but a frustrating task, especially when you know what you are trying to feed is good for them and they turn their nose up at it.

Identify if there is a reason your horse won't eat

If your horse is normally a great eater and suddenly goes off their feed, mouldy or unpalatable feed could be the issue. But if this isn't the case or if they exhibit signs of colic, ensure you contact your vet.

There can also be other underlying reasons why your horse may lack an appetite, including pain either from osteoarthritis, issues with their teeth or gums, gastric ulcers or pain in their hindgut if fed raw grains.

If any of these are identified, treat them appropriately and adjust their diet (as per above recommendations for gastric ulcers and hindgut dysbiosis) and their appetite should return.

Take their feed back to basics

If your horse is fed a mix of numerous feeds and supplements, there may be one thing (or a combination) that they don't like the taste of. Take their diet back to one 'hard' feed with no supplements and gradually re-introduce feeds and supplements to try and find the root cause of their fussiness. Something as simple as too much salt can stop them from eating.

Try the EasiFeed Selector tool on our website, or reach out to the Pryde's team if you want help creating a balanced diet that doesn't contain too many different feeds or supplements.

Allow grazing on pasture if you can

Often horses will go off their feed when at an event and being stabled (which they may not be used to), so giving them time to graze can often help to stimulate their appetite, or at the very least get them eating something while away.

Even the fussiest horses are generally happy to eat pasture or some highly palatable lucerne hay.

Make changes to their diet gradually

It is best to gradually introduce new feeds or supplements to your horse's diet. While this is good practice for all horses, it is particularly important for fussy eaters.

It's also important to keep their feed consistent from home to competition or travel, as sudden changes can cause them to turn up their noses. If you know your horse tends to not eat their normal feed when away from home but will eat certain other feeds, it can be helpful to begin introducing these favoured feeds at home rather than trying to do it when they are away.





Section 3

EasiMash

A mash that's also a complete feed

At Pryde's, we love helping horses stay happy and healthy. So we spend quite a bit of time dreaming up feeds and asking ourselves **'What IF...'**.

One day we wondered, '**What IF we could create a mash that was also a complete feed?'** Something packed with fibre, lots of quality protein, cool energy sources, and gut-friendly ingredients, that was also balanced with vitamins and minerals... It would have to be delicious too... making it the quintessential all-singing, all-dancing unicorn of horse feeds.

And you definitely can't leave a question like that unanswered... So we got to work and made it for you. Or for your horse, to be exact.

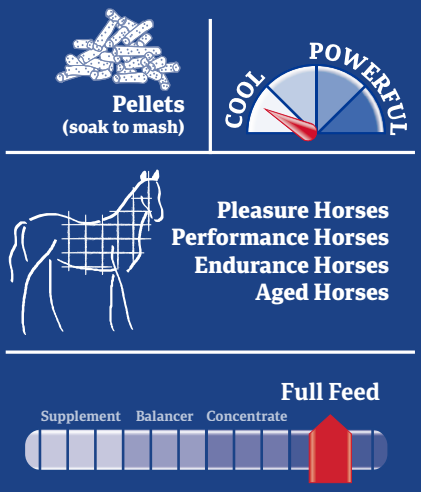


EasiMash

A mash that's also a complete feed

A cool energy mash with fibre, stabilised rice bran for calories and added protein to assist with muscle building.







WHY EasiMash?

Contains **Australian stabilised rice bran,** rich in **branch-chain amino acids** (BCAAs) including **leucine** to assist with muscle building and **post-exercise muscle recovery.**

Fortified with vitamins and minerals and packed with fibre, protein and energy making it a **one feed solution.**

Contains a **yeast prebiotic, red marine algae (acid buffer) and enzymes** which may support **gut health.**

Adds **fibre diversity,** which is associated with supporting functional diversity in the hindgut microbiome and a **healthier, more resilient gut!**

Contains **13% oil** from Australian stabilised rice bran, full fat soybean, and canola oil, to provide nutrients for **brilliant coat shine** and **sustained energy.**

Pryde's **EasiMash...** it's Lick the Bowl Clean Good!

Feeding Rates & Directions (kg/day)

	Bodyweight (kg)				
	300	**400**	**500**	**600**	**700**
Idle/Spelling	0.5 - 0.75	0.75 - 1.25	1.0 - 1.5	1.25 - 1.75	1.5 - 2.0
Recovery/Aged Horses	0.75 - 1.25	1.0 - 1.5	1.5 - 2.0	1.75 - 2.25	2.0 - 2.5
Light Exercise	0.75 - 1.25	1.0 - 1.5	1.5 - 2.0	1.75 - 2.25	2.0 - 2.5
Moderate Exercise	1.25 - 1.75	1.5 - 2.0	2.0 - 2.5	2.5 - 3.0	3.0 - 3.5
Intense Exercise	1.75 - 2.25	2.0 - 2.5	2.5 - 3.0	3.0 - 3.5	3.5 - 4.0

Recovery: Recovery from illness or injury. Not in work.
Light Exercise: Up to 60 mins walking, or 30 mins walking, trotting and cantering.
Moderate Exercise: Up to 120 mins walking and trotting, or 30-60 mins trotting, cantering and some galloping.
Intense Exercise: 30-60 mins intense skill work, short duration galloping, racing and endurance.

For the Best Results

- Introduce into a horse's ration gradually over 2 weeks.
- Feed in conjunction with ample forage (pasture, hay and/or chaff).
- Make clean, fresh water and salt available at all times.
- Adjust the amount fed so it is appropriate for a horse's body fatness, stage of training and workload, along with the quality and quantity of forage available.
- Divide feeds into two or more smaller meals if feeding more than 0.5 kg per 100 kg ofbodyweight in 'hard feed' per day.
- **Pryde's EasiMash** can be fed dry or wet (soaked). When feeding soaked, add 0.5L of cold or warm water to every 1kg of **Pryde's EasiMash**.
- The feeding rates given here are based on the amount of feed needed to meet a horse's vitamin and mineral requirements. If you feed below these feeding rates, vitamin and mineral deficiencies will appear in the diet and may affect health and limit performance. To avoid this, simply add one of **Pryde's EasiBalanced** Pellets to top up vitamin and mineral intakes.



Ingredients

Stabilised Rice Bran, Lupin Hulls, Lucerne Leaf Meal, Extruded Full Fat Soybean, Canola Oil, Red Marine Algae, Salt, Yeast Prebiotic, Pryde's Performance Horse Trace Mineral and Vitamin Premix, Magnesium Oxide, Natural Vitamin E, Vitamin B1 and enzymes to assist absorption.

Keep it Balanced



Are you feeding below recommended feeding rates? Top up vitamin and mineral levels using a pellet from the **Pryde's EasiBalanced** range. For every 1 kg less than the recommended feeding rates, add ONE of these products at the specified rate.

Elite 300	60g/day
EasiKeeper	200g/day
Essentials 150	400g/day
Premium 250	400g/day
High Cal	400g/day

Pryde's EasiMash... it's Lick the Bowl Clean Good!



Section 4

Hero ingredients (all of them)

By now you know that at Pryde's, we're transparent. That means we're happy to explain not only exactly **what** goes into our feeds, but also **why** it made the cut.

Not everyone wants to know these finer details, but as folks who just love a bit of nutrition nerdery ourselves, we thought some of you might like to know too.

Stabilised rice bran

High in quality protein (essential amino acids), packed with oil for 'cool' energy, and replete with highly digestible starch, stabilised rice bran is a bit of a star in the world of horse-feed ingredients.

It contains the amino acid leucine – an essential Branched Chain Amino Acid (BCAA) which plays a critical role in switching on the muscle building process.

Stabilised rice bran also contains as much biotin as a fortified feed, so it can help support strong, healthy hooves.

Lupin hulls

High in digestible fibre, lupin hulls provide a great source of 'cool' fibre-based energy in the diet. They also add fibre diversity to a horse's diet and can have a positive effect on the hindgut microbiome.

Lucerne leaf meal

Rich in quality protein and calcium (which has beneficial gastric acid buffering effects), lucerne leaf meal is a high fibre energy source that's nutritious and delicious.

Extruded full fat soy

With the best profile of essential amino acids (think high quality protein) of any plant, extruded full-fat soy is also a great source of 'cool' energy from oil and fibre.

Canola oil

Highly digestible and full of 'cool' energy, canola oil may also assist with attaining a beautiful, shiny mane, tail and coat.

Red marine algae

It's a rich source of marine derived calcium, which may assist with buffering gastric acid.

Salt

Horses sweat a lot! Especially those who live in hot or humid climates, and that sweat contains salt (NaCl). All horse diets should contain some salt but it's important that they aren't overfed salt either.

Yeast prebiotic

Prebiotics are essentially food sources for the 'good' microbes in your horse's hindgut and may help to support the health of the hindgut microbiome.

Pryde's performance horse trace mineral and vitamin premix & magnesium oxide

This mix provides a balanced level of vitamins and minerals in order to meet your horse's vitamin and mineral requirements. Forage alone and unfortified feeds will not provide your horse with all they need, which is why we specifically balance our feeds with a vitamin and mineral premix.

Natural vitamin E

This helps provide antioxidant protection against free radical damage, particularly in exercising horses.

Vitamin B1

Also known as Thiamine, vitamin B1 is essential for healthy nerve function, has a role in the metabolism of carbohydrates and proteins, and assists with maintaining a horse'appetite.

Enzymes

Enzymes may assist with the digestion and absorption of feed ingredients.



Got questions? We'd love to help! Email the Pryde's EasiFeed Team at nutrition@prydes.com.au